

attackers indicates that it was more than just a serious security failure ("The Ides of March", March 16). It is fortuitous that the cricketers managed to escape with minor injuries but the fact remains that Pakistan is fast sliding into anarchy. The strife-torn country is hurtling back into the army's control. This disarray spells trouble in the present surcharged political environment.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Poll Dance

The Third Front's second chance at staking claim speaks volumes about the viability of our democratic system ("Repeat Value", March 16). The agenda of the smorgasbord of diverse prime ministerial aspirants will be driven from the backseat by the communists. All rhetoric is rich in generalisations and bereft of meaningful commitments. Asymmetric multipolarity is promising to destabilise our polity again; it is time for national parties to save their space by getting rid of their confrontationist gridlock.

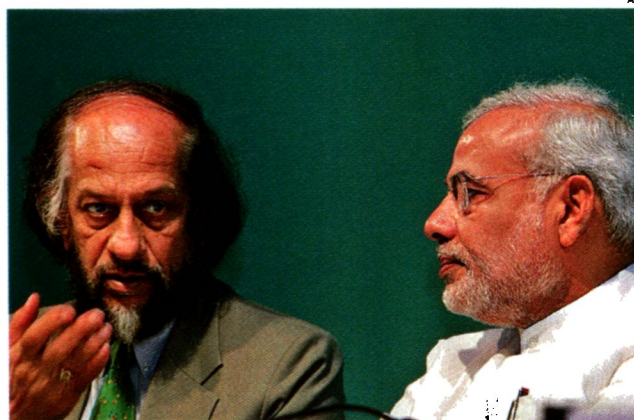
BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Sinister Stance

It is unfortunate that Sister Jesme faced sexual harassment in a place where morality is the basic structure ("Sins of the Fathers", March 9). Such barbarous

acts of reverend priests should be condemned by all. But why did she continue to stay with those sex-thirsty and corrupt priests and lesbian nuns for 33 long years? Why did she not leave the Order when she came to know about sexual exploitation and corruption? Was it greed for money or lust for power that prevented her from resigning? Sympathy for her is highly misplaced

or won an award or critical acclaim ("It's Mediocre at Best", March 2)? He says when a foreigner calls us slumdogs, we don't complain but when an Indian calls a barber by his name, we protest? How can Priyadarshan, a well-known plagiarist, dare to compare his *Billu* with *Slumdog Millionaire*. *Boeing-Boeing*, one of his earlier



In accepting the challenges of climate change and global warming, Chief Minister Narendra Modi has turned Gujarat into 'neighbour's envy, owner's pride.'

A. SRIKANTAIAH, via www.indiatoday.in

as she was to an extent part of the crime that she is complaining about now. P. ALWARAPPAN,
via www.indiatoday.in

Copy Right

What is Priyadarshan's grudge—the intentional exploitation of India or the fact that none of his movies have excelled,

movies in Malayalam, recently remade as *Garam Masala*, was an adaptation of a Jerry Lewis and Tony Curtis comedy of the same name. At least *Slumdog* wasn't a remake or a copied film. The grapes are indeed sour, Priyadarshan. THOMAS GEORGE,
via www.indiatoday.in

30
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INDIA
TODAY

MAY 1-15, 1979

Back to the Wall

Caught in a pincer attack between the Janata Party's Special Courts move and from her rebellious partymen, Mrs Indira Gandhi, the imperious Empress of the Emergency, is now fighting for her political survival. Despite her attempts to quash the Special Courts Bill, it was passed through Rajya Sabha where the Opposition enjoys a majority. Now it is only a matter of time before it becomes law. Hard political realities are staring starkly in her face. The Special Courts Bill, designed to bring to book those responsible for the excesses committed during the 1975-77 Emergency, is sending cold shivers down her spine. Her partymen and women who have perceived the shape of things to come have pointed out the danger signals, but her arrogance and misplaced sense of grandeur have so far prevented her from coming to terms with her political doom.

Arul B. Louis



INDIRA
GANDHI

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